"*Reasons to be considered for justificinge the undertakeres of the intended Plantation in New England, & for incouraginge such whose hartes God shall move to ioyne wth them in it.*

"1. It will be a service to the Church of great consequence to carry the Gospell into those parts of the world, to helpe on the comminge of the fullnesse of the Gentiles, & to raise a Bulworke against the kingdome of AnteChrist wch the Jesuites labour to reare up in those parts.

"2. All other churches of Europe are brought to desolation, & o^r^ sinnes, for wch the Lord begimnes allreaddy to frowne upon us & to cutte us short, doe threatne evill times to be comminge upon us, & whoe knowes, but that God hath provided this place to be a refuge for many whome he meanes to save out of the generall callamity, & seeinge the Church hath noe place lefte to flie into but the wildernesse, what better worke can there be, then to goe & provide tabernacles & foode for her against she comes thether:

"3. This Land growes weary of her Inhabitants, soe as man, whoe is the most pretious of all creatures, is here more vile & base then the earth we treade upon, & of lesse prise among us then an horse or a sheepe: masters are forced by authority to entertaine servants, parents to mainetaine there owne children, all townes complaine of the burthen of theire poore, though we have taken up many unnessisarie yea unlawfull trades to mainetaine them, & we use the authoritie of the Law to hinder the increase of o^r^ people, as by urginge the Statute against Cottages, & inmates, & thus it is come to passe, that children, servants & neighboures, especially if they be poore, are compted the greatest burthens, wch if thinges weare right would be the cheifest earthly blessinges.

"4. The whole earth is the Lords garden & he hath given it to the Sonnes of men wth a gen^l^ Comission: Gen: 1: 28: increace & multiplie, & replenish the earth & subdue it, wch was againe renewed to Noah: the end is double & naturall, that man might enioy the fruits of the earth, & God might have his

due glory from the creature: why then should we stand striving here for places of habitation, etc, (many men spending as much labour & coste to recover or keepe sometimes an acre or twoe of Land, as would procure them many & as good or better in another Countrie) & in the meane time suffer a whole Continent as fruitfull & convenient for the use of man to lie waste wthout any improvement?

"5. We are growne to that height of Intemperance in all excesse of Riott, as noe mans estate allmost will suffice to keepe saile wth his æqualls: & he whoe failes herein, must live in scorne & contempt. Hence it comes that all artes & Trades are carried in that deceiptfull & unrighteous course, as it is allmost impossible for a good & upright man to mainetayne his charge & live comfortablie in any of them.

"6. The ffountaines of Learning & Religion are soe corrupted as (besides the unsupportable charge of there education) most children (even the best witts & of fairest hopes) are perverted, corrupted, & utterlie overthrowne by the multitude of evill examples & the licentious governm^{t} of those seminaries, where men straine at knatts & swallowe camells, use all severity for mainetaynance of cappes & other accomplyments, but suffer all ruffianlike fashions & disorder in manners to passe uncontrolled.

"7. What can be a better worke, & more honorable & worthy a Christian then to helpe raise & supporte a particular Church while it is in the Infancy, & to ioyne his forces wth such a company of faithfull people, as by a timely assistance may growe stronge & prosper, & for wante of it may be put to great hazard, if not wholly ruined:

"8. If any such as are knowne to be Godly, & live in wealth & prosperity here, shall forsake all this, to ioyne themselves wth this Church & to runne an hazard wth them of an hard & meane condition, it will be an example of great use both for removinge the scandall of worldly & sinister respects wch is cast upon the Adventurers; to give more life to the faith of Gods people, in their praiers for the Plantation; & to incorrage others to ioyne the more willingly in it.

"9. It appeares to be a worke of God for the good of his Church, in that he hath disposed the hartes of soe many of his wise & faithfull servants, both ministers & others, not onely to approve of the enterprise but to interest themselves in it, some in their persons & estates, other by their serious advise & helpe otherwise, & all by their praiers for the wealfare of it. Amos 3: the Lord revealeth his secreat to his servants the prophetts, it is likely he hath some great worke in hand wch he hath revealed to his prophetts among us, whom he hath stirred up to encourage his servants to this Plantation, for he doth not use to seduce his people by his owne prophetts, but comitte that office to the ministrie of false prophetts & lieing spiritts.

"*Diverse obiections wch have been made against this Plantation, wth their answears & Resolutions:*

"Ob: 1: We have noe warrant to enter upon that Land wch hath been soe longe possessed by others:

"Ans: 1: That wch lies comon, & hath never beene replenished or subdued, is free to any that possesse & improve it: ffor God hath given to the sonnes of men a double right to the earth; theire is a naturall right, & a civill right. The first right was naturall when men held the earth in comon every man sowing & feeding where he pleased: then as men & theire Cattell encreased, they appropriated certaine parcells of Grounde by inclosinge & peculiar manuerance, & this in time gatte them a civill right: such was the right wch Ephron the Hittite had in the feild of Mackpelah wherein Abraham could not bury a dead Cerpes wthout leave, though for the out parts of the Countrie wch lay comon he dwelt upon them, & tooke the fruite of them at his pleasure: the like did Jacob, who fedde his Cattell as bouldly in Hamors Land, (for he is said to be Lord of the Countrie) & in other places where he came, as the native Inhabitants themselves: & that in those times & places men accompted noething theire owne, but that wch they had appropriated by theire owne industry, appeares plainely by this, that Abimileckes Servants in there owne Countrie, when they

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